



◀ **ASUS RT-AC68U**
Price: ₹18,000

Routers

An ordinary year for routers since there hasn't been a huge leap in throughput nor has there been any new feature that managed to make a considerable impact. AC1900 devices started appearing on the market and it can be said that the products are simply following the evolutionary path. All WiFi protocols use amplitude modulation and over the years the density of the modulation has increased and TurboQAM is what Broadcom is calling their implementation of the feature.

Broadcom's BCM4360 is what lies at the heart of all AC1900 devices currently available. The BCM4360 is capable of running three spatial streams and is the reason why we get 600Mbps on the 2.4GHz band and 1300Mbps on the 5GHz band. Certain companies still tend to use an inexpensive chip on the 2.4GHz band since that throughput is not going to increase in the next year or so. 802.11ad is still in the works and by the looks of it would be way ahead of its time given the massive 7Gbps throughput that it's designed to provide.

There are about three AC1900 devices on the market at the moment namely, ASUS RT-AC68U, Netgear Nighthawk and Linksys EA6900. Moreover, they are all using the BCM4360 for each band. However, we did see that the first dual core processor has made its way into routers and it seems that a new battle is about to begin in the routers segment.



TP-Link TD-W8968
Price: ₹2,349

BEST BUY:



DG-BR4000N/E
Price: ₹1,300

(Single Band)
Digisol DG-BR4000N/E happens to be a run of the mill budget router with 802.11n 150Mbps support. Compared to others in its price range it offers the most features and that is what won it the Best Buy Award for routers.



DIR-810L
Price: ₹3,799

(Dual Band)
The D-Link DIR-810L offers decent throughput to manage a minimum of two clients streaming HD content on the 5GHz band while all the rest are surfing away happily on the 2.4GHz band without worry.

Zero1 Winner ASUS RT-AC68U

Being the only AC1900 router that we tested this year, it came as no surprise when the ASUS RT-AC68U took the crown. The router is built well and has three adjustable antennae so there was nothing out of the ordinary when viewed from outside. The firmware is a modified DD-WRT which is quite feature heavy on its own and moreover since this happens to be the flagship product it enjoys regular updates. The router is ideal for environments with lots of clients and a heck lot of large sized file transfers. Did we mention that this happens to be the first router that has a dual core processor at its heart? Yup, that and two USB ports (1x USB 2.0 and 1x USB 3.0) at the back complete the package.

Notable Mentions TP-Link TD-W8968

For starters, it has a high enough throughput to handle two or three clients and stream HD media simultaneously. The two 5 dBi antenna coupled with its base transmit power is enough to ensure good signal coverage throughout an average middle-class house. It supports ADSL as well as cable connection both of which make up for the most prevalent types of internet connections in the country. On top of that it has a USB 2.0 port. Overall, it seems like the folks over at TP-Link were determined to give the customer as many features possible within a feasible price point.